

Funded Graduate Scouting Report

Professor-led funded MSc/PhD pathways for Sowrav Chowdhury

Updated: 2026-05-08 | Profile anchor: respiratory sound AI, biomedical signal processing, low-cost clinical monitoring, Augmedix healthcare workflow exposure

Executive Decision

Your best-funded route is not a generic AI master's. The strongest route is a funded PhD or research-funded MASc/PhD in labs that already understand digital auscultation, biomedical signals, wearable sensing, clinical AI, and low-resource health technology.

A. Refined Research Identity

Best-fit label: AI-enabled respiratory sound and biomedical signal analysis for low-cost clinical monitoring, strengthened by U.S. healthcare workflow and clinical data operations exposure.

- Core evidence: BSc EEE, CGPA 3.77/4.00, digital stethoscope thesis, pediatric pneumonia detection with 1D-CNN.
- Research evidence: 1,872 lung sound recordings from 117 pediatric subjects; hospital-based data collection; IEEE and MDPI publications.
- Clinical workflow evidence: Augmedix Medical Data Processor / Squad Lead supporting HCA Florida ED workflows, EHR data quality, Meditech 5 ICC, provider preferences, documentation KPIs, SQL/reporting, Retool, ClickUp.
- Application identity: low-cost digital health tools that survive real clinical workflow constraints.

B. Scoring Metric

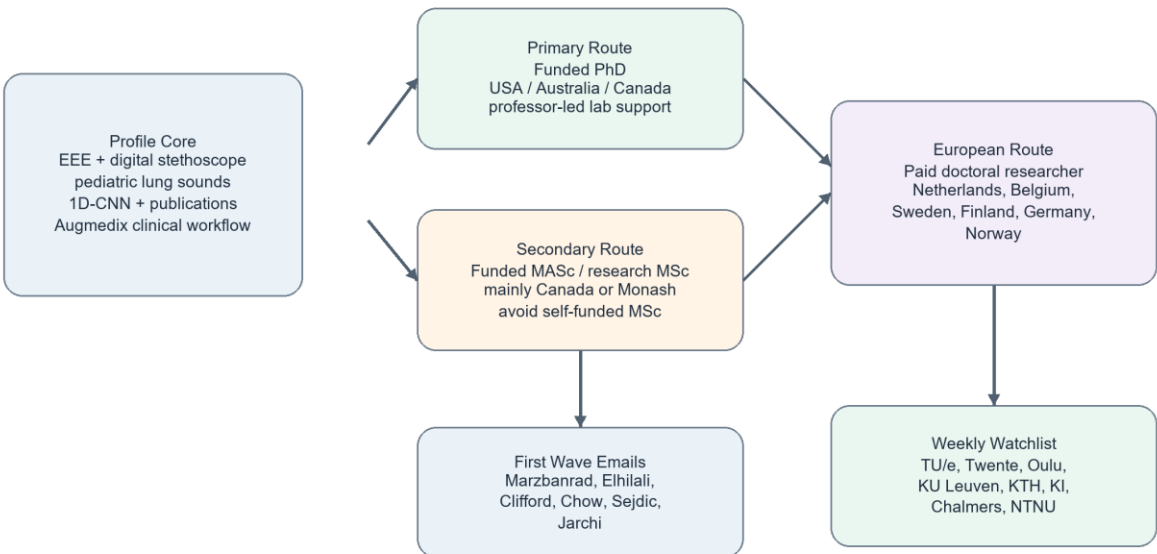
Overall score = weighted score across five dimensions. The weights intentionally reward research fit and funding realism more than prestige.

32%	24%	14%	15%	15%
Research match	Funding likelihood	Supervisor access	Country exit value	Admissions fit

Score interpretation: 8.0+ = first-wave target; 7.0-7.9 = strong second-wave or watchlist; below 7.0 = contact only if a funded project appears.

C. Route Flowchart

Decision Flow: Funded Exit Pathway for Sowrav Chowdhury

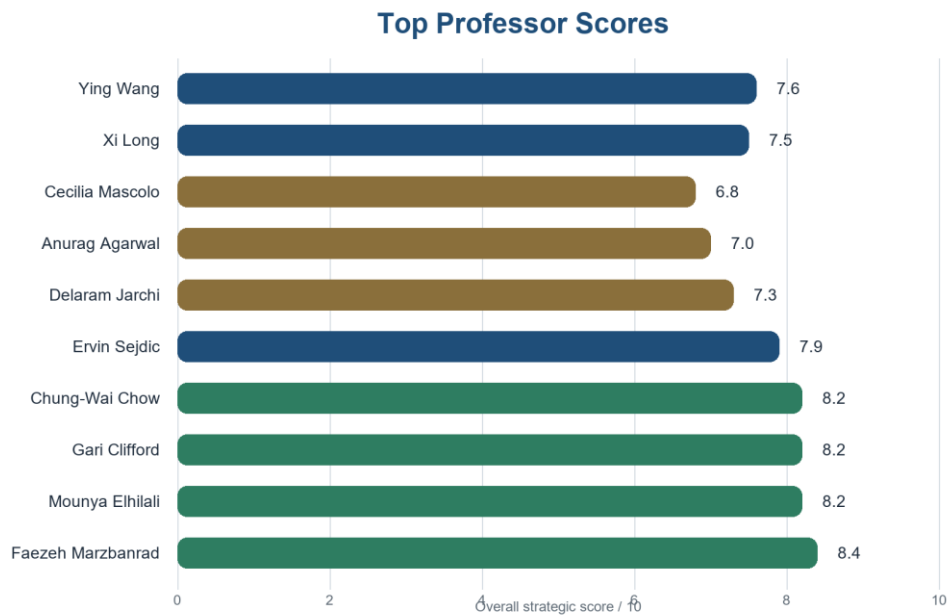


Rule: lead with respiratory-sound/biosignal research; use Augmedix as clinical deployment evidence.

D. Best-Fit Professors

Rank	Professor	University	Country	Fit	Funding	Overall	Action
1	Faezeh Marzbanrad	Monash University	Australia	10	7	8.4	Email immediately
2	Mounya Elhilali	Johns Hopkins University	USA	10	8	8.2	Email immediately
3	Gari Clifford	Emory University / Georgia Tech	USA	9	8	8.2	Email immediately
4	Chung-Wai Chow	University of Toronto / UHN	Canada	8	8	8.2	Email immediately
5	Ervin Sejdic	University of Toronto	Canada	8	8	7.9	Email immediately
6	Delaram Jarchi	University of Essex	UK	8	5	7.3	Email immediately
7	Anurag Agarwal	University of Cambridge	UK	9	5	7.0	Email selectively
8	Cecilia Mascolo	University of Cambridge	UK	8	5	6.8	Email selectively
9	Xi Long	Eindhoven University of Technology	Netherlands	8	7	7.5	Monitor + concise email
10	Ying Wang	University of Twente	Netherlands	8	7	7.6	Monitor + concise email
11	Tapio Seppanen	University of Oulu	Finland	8	7	7.5	Monitor doctoral calls
12	Maarten De Vos	KU Leuven	Belgium	8	7	7.5	Monitor + email
13	Carolina Varon Perez	KU Leuven	Belgium	8	7	7.5	Monitor + email
14	Seraina Dual	KTH Royal Institute of	Sweden	7	7	7.2	Monitor

		Technology					
15	Fernando Seoane	Karolinska Institutet / University of Boras	Sweden	7	7	7.0	Monitor
16	Ilangko Balasingham	NTNU	Norway	7	7	7.2	Monitor
17	Alexander von Luhmann	TU Berlin / BIFOLD	Germany	7	7	7.2	Monitor
18	Wenyao Xu	University at Buffalo	USA	7	7	7.3	Second wave



E. Professor Intelligence Notes

Professor	Lab / Unit	Exact Match	Likely Funding Route	Recommended Email Angle
Faezeh Marzbanrad	Biomedical Signal Processing Research Lab	Direct digital stethoscope, neonatal heart/lung sound quality, breath sound monitoring, affordable medical devices, ML and signal processing.	RTP/MGS scholarship; Monash Graduate Scholarship supports international research doctorate and research master's candidates.	Digital stethoscope + pediatric lung sounds + signal quality + low-resource monitoring.
Mounya Elhilali	Laboratory for Computational Audio Perception	AI-powered pediatric lung sound analysis, smart digital stethoscope, noise-robust auscultation, low-resource pneumonia diagnostics.	Strong NIH grant signal; JHU Whiting PhD funding/advisor support is the route.	Pediatric pneumonia auscultation AI + Bangladesh/LMIC relevance + noise-robust lung sounds.
Gari Clifford	Clifford Lab	Low-cost systems, edge computing, biomedical signal processing, mHealth, global health, maternal-child health and resource-limited settings.	Funded PhD via Emory BMI or Georgia Tech/Emory BME route; lab scale and grants are strong signals.	Low-cost biomedical signal AI + global health + Augmedix clinical workflow literacy.
Chung-Wai Chow	Respiratory oscillometry and lung function ML	New lung-function measurement technologies, respiratory oscillometry, ML interpretation and diagnosis, engineer-clinician collaboration.	U Toronto PhD funded cohort; potential MSc/PhD through supervisor and programme funding.	Funded MASc/PhD; pitch EEE, publications, clinical signal processing, EHR data quality.
Ervin Sejdic	Biomedical signal processing / AI for health outcomes	Biomedical signal processing, advanced information systems in medicine, assistive and anticipatory medical devices.	U Toronto ECE states MASc and PhD students receive guaranteed funding.	Funded MASc/PhD; pitch EEE, publications, clinical signal processing, EHR data quality.
Delaram Jarchi	CSEE physiological sensing and wearables	Wearable sensors, respiratory rate estimation, unobtrusive physiological parameter monitoring, clinical validation.	Explicitly invites PhD contact, but funding must be found via studentship/scholarship/project.	Use respiratory sound and physiological monitoring as the anchor; ask only around funded routes.
Anurag Agarwal	Acoustics Lab	Smart stethoscope, body sound sensors, stethoscope acoustics, heart/lung sound propagation and machine learning.	Excellent fit but UK international funding risk is high; only proceed with supervisor-linked funding/CDT/scholarship.	Use respiratory sound and physiological monitoring as the anchor; ask only around funded routes.
Cecilia Mascolo	Mobile Systems Research Lab	Respiratory disease progression through longitudinal audio data, mobile sensing, wearables, on-device ML and health monitoring.	Strong topic fit but Cambridge funding is highly competitive for international applicants.	Use respiratory sound and physiological monitoring as the anchor; ask only around funded routes.
Xi Long	Biomedical Diagnostics Lab / Signal Processing Systems	Signal processing, time-series analysis, trustworthy ML, unobtrusive vital signs, sleep, neonatal/maternal health, clinical decision support.	Best through paid PhD employee vacancy or e/MTIC/Philips-linked project.	Ask about paid doctoral/project openings; position as biosignal + clinical workflow applicant.
Ying Wang	Biomedical Signals and Systems	Hybrid AI with physiological mechanistic models for daily-life health monitoring; multimodal signal analysis and children-heart projects.	Best through advertised paid PhD project in BSS or EU doctoral network.	Ask about paid doctoral/project openings; position as biosignal + clinical workflow applicant.
Tapio Seppanen	Physiological Signal Analysis Group	Physiological signal analysis, cardiovascular and respiratory systems, telemedicine, remote health monitoring, clinical materials.	Doctoral education funded through doctoral programmes, teaching tasks, research groups, foundations.	Ask about paid doctoral/project openings; position as biosignal + clinical workflow applicant.
Maarten De Vos	STADIUS / iSi Health	AI solutions for health, personalized biosignatures, unobtrusive physiological systems, wearable health	Belgian paid PhD/FWO/project routes; search lab vacancies before applying.	Ask about paid doctoral/project openings; position as biosignal + clinical workflow applicant.

		monitoring.		
Carolina Varon Perez	STADIUS	Machine learning, biomedical signal processing, wearable technology, sleep monitoring and unobtrusive health monitoring.	Belgian project/FWO route; watch STADIUS/KU Leuven vacancies.	Ask about paid doctoral/project openings; position as biosignal + clinical workflow applicant.
Seraina Dual	Intelligent Heart Technology Lab	Biomedical signal processing, implantable and wearable sensors, health monitoring, pulmonary-hypertension quality-control ML project listed.	Swedish doctoral student employment; apply to advertised positions.	Ask about paid doctoral/project openings; position as biosignal + clinical workflow applicant.
Fernando Seoane	Medical Technology and Digital Health / p-Health wearable electronics	Wearable measurement systems, biosignal processing, noninvasive physiological measurements, biomedical data analysis.	KI doctoral student employment/salary ladder if project opens.	Ask about paid doctoral/project openings; position as biosignal + clinical workflow applicant.
Ilangko Balasingham	Signal Processing Group / Sensor Network Research	Medical signal processing, ML/AI for medical applications, body-area sensor networks, vital signs sensing.	Norwegian PhD fellowships are paid employee roles; apply to advertised vacancies.	Ask about paid doctoral/project openings; position as biosignal + clinical workflow applicant.
Alexander von Luhmann	Intelligent Biomedical Sensing Lab	Miniaturized wearables, body-worn sensors, ML biomarkers from complex biosignals, real-world physiological monitoring.	German project/research staff PhD route; monitor lab/TU Berlin/BIFOLD jobs.	Ask about paid doctoral/project openings; position as biosignal + clinical workflow applicant.
Wenyao Xu	Embedded Sensing and Computing Group	AIoT, wireless sensing, digital health, body sensor networks, biomedical signal analytics, telemedicine; actively looking for doctoral candidates.	US PhD funding possible through CSE/PI; fit is broader than respiratory sounds.	Use respiratory sound and physiological monitoring as the anchor; ask only around funded routes.

F. Funded Master's Opportunities

University	Route	Funding Realism	Strategic Notes
University of Toronto ECE	MASc	High	Research-stream MASc and PhD funding is a strong Canada route; supervisor fit matters.
Monash	Master by Research	Medium	MGS supports research master's, but international scholarship competition is serious.
University of Essex	PhD preferred	Low/medium	Supervisor is accessible; funded MSc is not the main path.
Cambridge	MPhil/PhD scholarship	Low	Academic fit can be strong, but unfunded offers are financially dangerous.
Europe employee-PhD countries	Master's not ideal	Low	Netherlands/Sweden/Norway/Finland/Germany are better as paid PhD vacancy routes.

G. Funded PhD / Paid Doctoral Routes

Route	Best Labs	Funding Mechanism	Realism	Action
USA funded PhD	JHU LCAP; Emory/GaTech Clifford; Buffalo ESC	Advisor/department/grant funding	Medium/high	Email first-wave and apply only funded.
Canada funded MASc/PhD	U Toronto ECE/IMS	Funded cohort, RA/TA/fellowship	High	Very strong practical route.
Australia research scholarship	Monash Marzbanrad Lab	RTP/MGS stipend + tuition	Medium	Prepare scholarship-grade EOI.
Netherlands paid PhD	TU/e Xi Long; Twente Ying Wang	Employee-style PhD vacancy	Medium/high	Monitor weekly.
Belgium paid/FWO PhD	KU Leuven De Vos; Varon	Project PhD/FWO	Medium	Monitor STADIUS/iSi Health.
Nordic paid PhD	Oulu, KTH, KI, Chalmers, NTNU	Doctoral employee/fellowship	Medium	Apply to posted positions.
UK funded project/CDT	Cambridge, Essex	Scholarship/CDT/project	Low/medium	Only pursue funded route.

H. University Requirements Snapshot

University	Route	Academic Fit	English	Documents	Funding	Timing
Monash	PhD / research master's	Strong BSc, research output, supervisor fit; Engineering favors top students/publications.	IELTS accepted; you have 7.5 overall.	CV, transcripts, research proposal/EOL, English evidence, publications.	MGS/RTP AUD 37,145 p.a. 2026 + tuition scholarship.	International R1 Mar 31; R3 Jul 31.
Johns Hopkins ECE	PhD	Competitive ECE/ML/signal profile; advisor fit critical.	TOEFL/IELTS unless waived.	SOP, CV, transcripts, recommendations, test scores if required.	WSE PhD/advisor support; NIH grant signal.	Annual fall cycle; verify current deadline.
Emory/GaTech	Biomedical Informatics / BME PhD	Engineering + biomedical signal processing + health data fit.	Programme-specific English proof.	SOP, CV, transcripts, recommendations, research statement.	Funded PhD via BMI/BME lab support.	Annual cycle; verify programme.
University of Toronto ECE	MASc / PhD	Competitive research-stream admission; direct PhD possible but MASc may be strategic.	English proof if not waived.	SGS + ECE application, CV, SOP, transcripts, references.	ECE guaranteed funding; UofT base PhD funding CAD 40,000 inclusive of tuition from Fall 2025.	Fall cycle; check ECE deadline.
Cambridge	PhD	Excellent academic/research record and supervisor/project fit.	Cambridge English requirement if required.	Online application, proposal, transcripts, references, English proof.	Cambridge Trust/Gates/CDT/project; very competitive.	Early Dec/Jan funding deadlines.
University of Essex	PhD	Relevant AI/ML/physiological sensing proposal.	Programme-specific English.	CV, proposal, transcripts, references.	Studentship/scholarship/project dependent.	Varies.
TU/e	Paid PhD	Vacancy-specific MSc-level requirements; EEE/signal profile useful.	Vacancy-specific English.	CV, motivation, transcripts, references.	Employee-style PhD vacancy.	Apply when posted.
University of Twente	Paid PhD	Vacancy-specific engineering/computing/signal analysis fit.	Vacancy-specific English.	CV, motivation, transcripts, references.	Employee-style PhD contract.	Apply when posted.
KU Leuven	Paid PhD / FWO	Master-equivalent and professor/project fit; BSc-only may need master's route depending vacancy.	Programme/project-specific English.	CV, motivation/research plan, transcripts, references.	Project PhD/FWO/departmental funding.	Apply to vacancies or supervisor-led calls.
Oulu	Doctoral researcher	Study rights + supervisor/research plan.	Programme-specific English.	Research plan, supervision agreement, transcripts, English evidence.	Doctoral programmes, research groups, teaching, foundations.	Calls vary.
KTH/KI/Chalmers/NTNU	Paid doctoral position	Vacancy-specific; often MSc-equivalent expected.	Project-specific English.	CV, transcripts, motivation, references.	Employee-style doctoral role.	Apply to advertised positions.

I. Country Strategy

Country	Best Mechanism	Realism	Cost Risk	Funding Chance	Recommendation
Canada	Funded MASc/PhD	High	Moderate	High	Best master's + PhD hybrid; prioritize U Toronto.
USA	Funded PhD	Medium/high	Low if funded	Medium	Target JHU, Emory/GaTech, Buffalo; avoid self-funded MS.
Australia	Research scholarship	Medium	Low if scholarship	Medium	Monash is a priority; scholarship competition is real.
Netherlands	Paid PhD vacancy	High if vacancy matches	Low	Medium	Monitor TU/e and Twente vacancies weekly.
Belgium	Paid PhD/FWO/project	Medium/high	Low	Medium	KU Leuven STADIUS/iSi Health is now worth active monitoring.
Sweden	Paid doctoral job	Medium	Low	Medium	Apply to advertised KTH/KI/Chalmers positions.
Finland	Doctoral researcher	Medium	Low if funded	Medium	Oulu is a strong physiological-signal watchlist item.
Germany	Research staff PhD	Medium	Low	Medium	Monitor TU Berlin/BIFOLD and hospital-tech jobs.
Norway	Paid PhD fellowship	Medium	Low	Medium	NTNU/OsloMet/Bergen; apply to official vacancies.
UK	Scholarship/CDT/project	Medium/low	Very high if unfunded	Low/medium	Email only best-fit labs; do not accept unfunded offers.

J. First-Wave Outreach List

Professor	Subject Line	Custom Fit Angle
Faezeh Marzbanrad	Prospective PhD applicant - digital stethoscope and pediatric respiratory sound AI	Lead with your 1,872-recording pediatric lung sound dataset, 117 subjects, digital stethoscope prototype, IEEE/MDPI publications, and low-resource health motivation.
Mounya Elhilali	Prospective PhD applicant - respiratory sound AI and low-resource digital auscultation	Lead with pediatric pneumonia, Bangladesh clinical collection, low-cost stethoscope, noise/signal-quality work, and interest in AI for auscultation.
Gari Clifford	Prospective PhD applicant - low-cost biomedical signal AI for global health	Lead with biomedical signal processing, low-cost systems, Augmedix clinical workflow, and global-health implementation constraints.
Chung-Wai Chow	MSc/PhD inquiry - ML for lung function and low-cost respiratory monitoring	Lead with respiratory clinical data, digital stethoscope work, and Augmedix EHR/documentation data quality exposure.
Ervin Sejdic	Prospective MASc/PhD applicant - biomedical signal processing for clinical monitoring	Lead with EEE, publications, physiological signal ML, TA/RA work, and data operations.
Delaram Jarchi	Prospective PhD applicant - respiratory sound and wearable physiological signal analysis	Lead with respiratory signals, wearable/remote monitoring interest, and her explicit PhD contact invitation.

K. Rejected / Deprioritized Targets

Target Type	Why Rejected or Deprioritized
Generic AI/data science labs	No health signal or clinical sensor focus; would flatten the profile into generic AI.
Imaging-only respiratory labs	Only useful if they also work with physiological signals or lung-function sensor data.
Wet-lab pulmonary biology groups	Do not naturally value digital stethoscope, 1D-CNN, and signal-processing work.
Administrative public health-only groups	Mission overlap but weak technical fit unless digital auscultation or clinical AI is central.
Molecular/proteomics AI groups	Computational but not body sounds, biosignals, or low-cost monitoring.
Unfunded UK/Australia MSc routes	High cost risk and weak exit strategy; use only if a scholarship covers cost.
Generic health informatics programmes	Augmedix evidence helps, but the route must still connect to clinical AI, EHR data quality, sensors, or digital health implementation.

L. 14-Day Action Plan

- Day 1-2: Build a one-page research profile focused on digital stethoscope, pediatric lung sounds, 1D-CNN, and clinical deployment constraints.
- Day 3-4: Prepare a master email template plus six customized first-wave versions.
- Day 5: Send first three emails: Marzbanrad, Elhilali, Clifford.
- Day 6: Send next three emails: Chow, Sejdic, Jarchi.
- Day 7-10: Prepare Canadian MASc/PhD application materials and identify U Toronto programme fit.
- Day 11-14: Set weekly vacancy monitoring for TU/e, Twente, KU Leuven, Oulu, KTH, KI, Chalmers, NTNU, TU Berlin.

Source Links Used

- <https://www.monash.edu/medicine/scs/researchers/faezeh-marzbanrad>
- <https://www.monash.edu/study/fees-scholarships/scholarships/find-a-scholarship/monash-graduate-scholarship-mgs?international=true>
- <https://engineering.jhu.edu/ece/news/ai-powered-lung-sound-analysis-shows-promise-for-improving-pediatric-pneumonia-diagnosis/>
- <https://engineering.jhu.edu/ece/ece-admissions/graduate-admission-info/>
- <https://gdclifford.info/>
- <https://med.emory.edu/departments/biomedical-informatics/about/index.html>
- <https://ims.utoronto.ca/faculty/chung-wai-chow>
- <https://www.sgs.utoronto.ca/about/whats-new-in-graduate-studies/graduate-funding/>
- <https://www.ece.utoronto.ca/people/sejdic-e/>
- <https://www.ece.utoronto.ca/graduates/financial-support/>
- <https://www.essex.ac.uk/people/JARCH68309/delaram-jarchi>
- <https://www.essex.ac.uk/postgraduate/research>
- <https://acoustics.eng.cam.ac.uk/about-us/>
- <https://www.eng.cam.ac.uk/postgraduates/postgraduate-courses/phd-engineering>
- <https://mobile-systems.cl.cam.ac.uk/reload.html>
- <https://www.postgraduate.study.cam.ac.uk/funding>
- <https://research.tue.nl/en/persons/xi-long/>
- <https://jobs.tue.nl/en/vacancies.html>
- <https://people.utwente.nl/ying.wang>

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- <https://www.oulu.fi/en/research-groups/physiological-signal-analysis-group>
- <https://www.oulu.fi/en/research/graduate-school/admissions>
- <https://gbiomed.kuleuven.be/english/research/50000737/research/HMB/isihealth/our-members/members/00050294>
- <https://www.kuleuven.be/english/research/phd>
- <https://www.esat.kuleuven.be/stadius/stadiusincludes/person.php?id=481>
- <https://www.kth.se/profile/seraina>
- <https://www.kth.se/en/studies/phd>
- <https://ki.se/en/people/fernando-seoane>
- <https://ki.se/en/education/doctoral-education>
- <https://www.ntnu.edu/employees/ilangkob>
- <https://www.ntnu.edu/vacancies>
- <https://ibs-lab.com/>
- <https://www.tu.berlin/en/jobs>
- <https://cse.buffalo.edu/~wenyaoxu/>
- <https://engineering.buffalo.edu/computer-science-engineering/graduate/degrees-and-programs/phd.html>

M. Verified Application Deadline and Process Matrix

Verification date: 2026-05-08. Deadlines change by cycle; confirm the live page before submission. For vacancy-based European routes, the deadline is the closing date of the advertised doctoral job, not a central admission date.

University	Professor(s)	Route	Deadline / Timing	How to Apply	Sowrav-Specific Action
Monash University	Faezeh Marzbanrad	PhD / MPhil / Master by Research	International scholarship rounds: R1 opens 1 Sep, closes 31 Mar; R3 opens 4 May, closes 31 Jul. Admission-only can be submitted year-round.	Identify supervisor/project, complete faculty pre-application steps, then submit one My.App application for research degree + scholarship, research degree only, or scholarship only. From Round 3 international 2026 onward, direct My.App is replacing older EOI steps in Engineering.	R3 2026 is the immediate scholarship round for Jan-Jun 2027 enrolment. Treat supervisor support as required before submission.
Johns Hopkins University ECE	Mounya Elhilali	ECE PhD; MSE as backup	Fall PhD deadline: 15 Dec 2025 for Fall 2026. MSE Fall deadline: 15 Feb 2026; Spring MSE: 1 Oct.	Apply through the WSE/ECE graduate application. Upload resume, SOP, 3 recommendations, transcripts, English proof if required; GRE is not required for PhD and optional for MSE.	Deadline cycle has passed for Fall 2026; start professor contact now for Fall 2027 and confirm if any lab-funded exception exists.
Emory University / Georgia Tech	Gari Clifford	CSI PhD with BMI concentration; Joint GT-Emory BME PhD	Joint GT-Emory BME Fall 2026 deadline: 1 Dec 2025. Emory PhD deadlines are program-specific through Laney Graduate School; PhD applications were closed by May 2026.	For BMI route, apply through Emory Laney/CSI, then align with BMI concentration and Clifford/BMI faculty. For BME route, apply to Joint GT-Emory BME through the designated portal.	High-fit route but annual deadline only. Contact Clifford/BMI before application because lab/advisor fit is central.
University of Toronto ECE	Ervin Sejdic	MASc / PhD	ECE application cycle uses Fall/Winter starts; review begins after the relevant program deadline. Current ECE page instructs applicants to select Fall 2026-Summer 2027 and complete both systems.	Complete both SGS and ECE applications. Submit CV/SOP, transcripts, references, English proof if needed, and supervisor/research alignment.	Canada strongest funded master-to-PhD route. Ask whether MASc is strategically better than direct PhD from BSc.
University of Toronto IMS	Chung-Wai Chow	MSc / PhD / Direct-entry PhD	International September 2026 deadline: 15 Mar 2026; early consideration: 1 Feb 2026. January 2027 international deadline: 15 Sep 2026.	Find a supervisor early, then apply online through SGS. IMS requires CV, transcripts, references, and program-specific materials.	Good respiratory-clinical fit; deadline windows are more explicit than ECE. For 2027 January entry, 15 Sep 2026 is the next official international deadline found.
University of Essex	Delaram Jarchi	PhD / studentship	April 2026 with visa deadline: 9 Feb 2026; without visa: 9 Mar 2026. October 2026 deadline was listed as to be confirmed. Studentships have separate deadlines.	Choose research degree, identify supervisor, prepare proposal/CV/transcripts/English proof, then submit through myEssex for Applicants. Funding applications may require an Essex course application by the funder deadline.	Supervisor accessible but funding risk is medium. Apply only with studentship/project plan or clear scholarship route.
University of Cambridge	Anurag Agarwal; Cecilia Mascolo	PhD Engineering / PhD Computer Science / funded project	Main University funding deadlines for 2026/27: 2 Dec 2025 and 7 Jan 2026, depending on course. Full application including references must be submitted by 23:59 GMT.	Contact potential supervisor, select course in the Course Directory, prepare research proposal and full online application, and submit by the course funding deadline if seeking Cambridge Trust/Gates/CDT funding.	Research fit is strong, cost risk is high. Use only if supervisor confirms a funded project/CDT path.
Eindhoven University of Technology (TU/e)	Xi Long	Paid doctoral candidate vacancy	No general annual PhD admission deadline found; apply when a doctoral vacancy is posted.	Monitor TU/e jobs/research portal. Apply to a posted doctoral-candidate project with CV, motivation, transcripts, references, and project-specific evidence.	Best route is employee-style paid PhD linked to Biomedical Diagnostics / Signal Processing Systems.
University of Twente	Ying Wang	Paid PhD position; self-funded/scholarship PhD	No annual deadline for regular paid PhD vacancies. Self-funded/scholarship route requires supervisor interest before documents are completed.	For regular PhD, apply through UT vacancies. For own funding, contact full professor/research group head with motivation, CV, two-page proposal, references, transcripts, English proof, and funding-provider details.	UT states most Dutch PhD researchers are paid employees; self-funded route carries fees and should not be primary.
University of Oulu	Tapio Seppanen	Doctoral study rights + funded doctoral researcher	Doctoral application periods: 1 Jan-30 Apr at 15:00 UTC+2 and 1 Jul-31 Oct at 15:00 UTC+3.	Discuss supervisor/funding first. Apply through Studyinfo.fi with degree certificate, transcript, language proof, supervision plan/commitment, research plan, and passport/ID.	Oulu separates study rights from employment. Funding plan with principal supervisor is essential before applying.

University	Professor(s)	Route	Deadline / Timing	How to Apply	Sowrav-Specific Action
KU Leuven	Maarten De Vos; Carolina Varon Perez	Project PhD / FWO / supervisor-started doctoral application	No general application deadline. Individual supervisors/projects may have deadlines.	You cannot initiate the KU Leuven doctoral application yourself; the KU Leuven supervisor starts it and sends a personal application link. Upload requested documents after the supervisor-created application exists.	BSc-only applicants may need a master-equivalent path unless the vacancy explicitly accepts the background.
KTH Royal Institute of Technology	Seraina Dual	Doctoral student employment	No general deadline. Apply to advertised vacant doctoral positions.	Find a vacant doctoral position that fits your background and apply through the link in the announcement. Non-EU/EEA admits then handle residence permit steps.	Use vacancy-specific language; do not send generic doctoral admission email without a matching opening.
Karolinska Institutet	Fernando Seoane	Advertised doctoral position	No general deadline. KI doctoral positions are advertised continuously.	Apply in KI's recruitment system to announced doctoral positions. Eligibility is assessed from the documents submitted with the position application; KI does not pre-assess eligibility by email.	A medical university fit is useful, but an engineering applicant needs a specific digital health / medtech doctoral posting.
Chalmers University of Technology	Andreas Fhager / Biomedical Signals and Systems watchlist	Doctoral student employment	No general deadline. Each vacancy has its own deadline; complete applications must arrive by 23:59 Swedish time on the advertised deadline date.	Apply to publicly announced doctoral positions via Chalmers vacancies/ReachMee. Doctoral students are normally employed by Chalmers.	New watchlist target because Biomedical Signals and Systems explicitly covers digital health, AI decision support, telemedicine, EMG, and biomedical signal processing.
NTNU	Ilangko Balasingham	Paid PhD candidate / PhD fellowship	No universal annual application deadline. PhD candidate jobs are posted as temporary academic posts; admission paperwork follows employment or external funding.	Apply to the relevant NTNU vacancy. PhD positions are typically 3-4 years. Admission requires funding plan, master's/equivalent education, strong academic record, research proposal, and supervision agreement.	Norway treats PhD candidates mostly as employees; funding is an absolute admission requirement.
TU Berlin	Alexander von Luhmann	Research staff PhD + faculty doctoral registration	Faculty IV says doctoral-candidate applications can be submitted at any time. Enrollment has semester registration/enrollment deadlines: summer registration 15 Jan-31 Aug, winter registration 15 Jul-28 Feb; enrollment fee deadlines 23 Sep / 23 Mar.	First secure supervisor/research-staff route, then submit declaration/application as doctoral candidate to the faculty with supervision agreement. Non-employed candidates must enroll after faculty acceptance.	Germany route is vacancy/research-staff first; faculty enrollment is administrative after doctoral acceptance.
University at Buffalo	Wenyao Xu	CSE PhD; BME PhD alternative	CSE Fall materials deadline: 31 Dec; recommended scholarship deadline: 10 Dec. BME Fall funding/fellowship consideration: 15 Jan, visa deadline 1 Mar or 1 Apr depending page; Spring visa deadline: 30 Sep or 1 Sep depending BME page.	Apply online through UB application system. Upload SOP, CV, transcripts, recommendations, English proof if required. CSE expects strong CS/math/engineering; BME asks PhD applicants to name research areas/faculty.	Good second-wave US target. Decide CSE vs BME based on whether the pitch is AIoT sensing or biomedical devices/signal diagnostics.

N. University Strategy Metrics

Region	Universities	Best Mechanism	Route Score	Decision Note
Canada	U Toronto ECE / IMS	Best funded MASc/PhD hybrid	8.6	Highest practical priority; January 2027 IMS deadline is actionable.
Australia	Monash	Best direct professor-topic match	8.4	R3 scholarship deadline 31 Jul 2026 is immediate.
USA	JHU / Emory-GT / Buffalo	Best fully funded PhD options	8.0	Annual deadlines mostly passed; build professor pipeline now.
Netherlands	TU/e / Twente	Paid employee PhD if vacancy aligns	7.8	Monitor weekly; MSc-equivalent language in vacancies can be a constraint.
Belgium	KU Leuven	Project/FWO PhD route	7.6	Supervisor must start KU Leuven doctoral application.
Nordics	Oulu / KTH / KI / Chalmers / NTNU	Paid doctoral employment or funded doctoral	7.4	Vacancy matching matters more than generic admission.

Region	Universities	Best Mechanism	Route Score	Decision Note
		researcher		
UK	Cambridge / Essex / Oxford / City St George's	Only with funded project/studentship	6.8	Excellent labs, but avoid unfunded offers.
Germany	TU Berlin	Research staff PhD	7.1	Find paid role first; enrollment comes after faculty acceptance.

O. Additional Professor Expansion List

These names expand the outreach pool beyond the first-wave list. Scores are not prestige scores; they estimate topical fit + funding practicality for this applicant profile.

Professor	University / Unit	Why Relevant	Fit Score	Likely Route	Use Case
Nasim Katebi	Emory Biomedical Informatics	AI/ML, biomedical signal and image processing, edge/tiny ML, global/public/rural health, maternal-child health.	8.0	BMI / CSI PhD through Emory; contact with CV and concise fit note.	Adds Clifford-adjacent backup inside same BMI ecosystem.
Reza Sameni	Emory Biomedical Informatics	Biomedical signal/image processing; cardiovascular and maternal-child health areas listed by BMI.	7.8	BMI / CSI PhD; signal-processing angle stronger than respiratory-specific angle.	Good for ECG/physiological signal extension from lung sounds.
Matthew Reyna	Emory Biomedical Informatics	AI/ML theory/applications, biostatistics/bioinformatics, high-performance computing, cancer/cardiovascular disease.	7.4	BMI / CSI PhD; computational-health pitch.	Backup if framing shifts toward clinical ML datasets and competitions.
Andreas Fhager	Chalmers, Biomedical Signals and Systems	Biomedical signals/systems group covering digital health, AI decision support, telemedicine, EMG, neuroengineering.	7.5	Advertised Chalmers doctoral employment.	Adds Sweden watchlist target beyond KTH/KI.
Nigel Lovell	UNSW Sydney Biomedical Engineering / IHealthE	Telehealth, biosignal processing, physiological modelling, biomonitoring; 800+ outputs and 110+ PhD completions reported by UNSW.	7.6	UNSW PhD scholarship route; supervisor contact before application.	Strong Australia backup for low-cost remote monitoring and clinical translation.
Socrates Dokos	UNSW Sydney Biomedical Engineering	Biomedical signal classification, computational modelling, biomedical engineering; 200+ outputs reported by UNSW.	7.1	UNSW PhD scholarship/project route.	Useful if profile expands toward modelling/classification of physiological signals.
Lionel Tarassenko	University of Oxford Engineering Science	Signal processing and ML in healthcare; acute-care deterioration, vital-sign monitoring, translation to clinical medicine.	7.4	Oxford DPhil funding/project route; supervisor/project dependent.	High-prestige/high-competition; strong clinical workflow narrative fit.
Panicos Kyriacou	City St George's, University of London	PPG, optical biosensors, wearable/non-invasive monitoring, biosignal processing; 300+ publications and six patents reported by university.	7.2	City St George's PhD/studentship route.	Good UK backup for sensor-device development, less respiratory-sound specific.
Roozbeh Jafari	Texas A&M University	Wearable computer design, signal processing, biosensors, medical devices, digital health; lab reports 200+ papers and \$86M+ raised.	7.7	Texas A&M BME/CSE/ECE PhD with advisor funding.	Excellent for wearable biosignal/edge-health pivot; very competitive.
Edward Sazonov	University of Alabama	Wearable sensors, body monitoring, signal processing and pattern recognition; NIH-funded wearable sensing work.	7.0	UA ECE/BME-adjacent graduate route; verify active openings.	Backup for wearable acoustic/behavioral sensing if respiratory focus broadens.

P. Practical Application Sequence

- Immediate: email Monash, U Toronto IMS/ECE, and any live European paid PhD vacancies; Monash R3 closes 31 July 2026.
- By July 2026: prepare a scholarship-grade research statement, two-page CV, publication sheet, and one-page respiratory-sound project concept.
- By August 2026: prepare IMS January 2027 application package; international deadline is 15 September 2026.
- Weekly: check TU/e, Twente, KU Leuven, KTH, KI, Chalmers, NTNU, TU Berlin, and Oulu vacancies using keywords respiratory, biosignal, wearable, digital health, clinical AI, signal processing, and edge AI.
- Fall 2026: prepare US Fall 2027 PhD applications for JHU, Emory/GT, Buffalo, and Texas A&M if professor responses are positive.

Q. Source Links Added in This Expansion

- Monash Graduate Research applying: <https://www.monash.edu/graduate-research/study/apply>
- Monash Engineering research application: <https://www.monash.edu/engineering/future-students/graduate-research/how-to-apply>
- Johns Hopkins ECE graduate admissions: <https://engineering.jhu.edu/ece/ece-admissions/graduate-admission-info/>
- Georgia Tech-Emory BME apply/deadlines: <https://bme.gatech.edu/apply-now>
- Emory BMI PhD: <https://med.emory.edu/departments/biomedical-informatics/education/phd.html>
- Emory BMI faculty/method areas: <https://med.emory.edu/departments/biomedical-informatics/people/faculty.html>
- University of Toronto ECE application instructions: <https://www.ece.utoronto.ca/graduates/admission/grad-application/>
- University of Toronto IMS deadlines: <https://ims.utoronto.ca/application-deadlines-and-requirements>
- University of Essex PGR applications: <https://www.essex.ac.uk/postgraduate/research/applying-to-essex>
- Cambridge university funding deadlines: <https://www.postgraduate.study.cam.ac.uk/funding/applying-university-funding>
- University of Twente PhD application/admission: <https://www.utwente.nl/en/education/tgs/interested-in/phd/application-admission/>
- University of Oulu doctoral admissions: <https://www.oulu.fi/en/research/graduate-school/admissions>
- University of Oulu how to apply: <https://www.oulu.fi/en/research/graduate-school/how-apply-doctoral-education>
- KU Leuven doctoral application instructions: <https://www.kuleuven.be/english/study/apply/application-instructions/instructions-doctoral>
- KTH doctoral application: <https://www.kth.se/en/studies/phd/how-to-apply-1.520089>
- Karolinska Institutet doctoral positions: <https://education.ki.se/doctoral-education/available-positions-for-doctoral-education>
- Karolinska Institutet entry requirements: <https://education.ki.se/doctoral-education/entry-requirements-to-doctoral-education-at-karolinska-institutet-ki>
- Chalmers doctoral studies: <https://www.chalmers.se/en/research/we-train-new-researchers/about-doctoral-studies/>
- Chalmers job applicants: <https://www.chalmers.se/en/about-chalmers/work-with-us/for-job-applicants/>
- Chalmers Biomedical Signals and Systems: <https://www.chalmers.se/en/departments/e2/research/signal-processing-and-biomedical-engineering/biomedical-signals-and-systems/>
- NTNU PhD application: <https://www.ntnu.edu/phd/application-phdprogramme>
- NTNU job application process: <https://www.ntnu.edu/positions/job-application-process>
- NTNU Engineering admission/financing: <https://www.ntnu.edu/studies/phiv/admission>
- TU Berlin doctoral enrollment: <https://www.tu.berlin/en/studierendensekretariat/applying-enrolling-for-doctoral-studies>
- TU Berlin Faculty IV doctorate: <https://www.tu.berlin/en/eecs/research/academic-career/doctorate>
- University at Buffalo CSE FAQ: <https://engineering.buffalo.edu/computer-science-engineering/graduate/admissions/faq.html>
- University at Buffalo BME application: <https://engineering.buffalo.edu/bme/education/how-to-apply.html>
- Oxford Lionel Tarassenko profile: <https://eng.ox.ac.uk/people/lionel-tarassenko/>

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- City St George's Panicos Kyriacou profile: <https://www.citystgeorges.ac.uk/about/people/academics/panicos-kyriacou>
- Texas A&M Roozbeh Jafari profile: <https://engineering.tamu.edu/electrical/profiles/jafari-roozbeh.html>
- UNSW Nigel Lovell profile: <https://research.unsw.edu.au/people/scientia-professor-nigel-lovell>
- UNSW Socrates Dokos profile: <https://www.unsw.edu.au/staff/socrates-dokos>